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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark Comparison

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Introduction — Why a robot-vacuum comparison matters in 2026

Households are buying robot vacuums at a record pace — sales jumped 22% year-over-year in 2026 — because pet hair, hectic schedules, and hybrid work make automated floor care a necessity.

But flashy marketing can hide the real differences in suction, navigation, and upkeep, leading you to pay for features you'll never use.

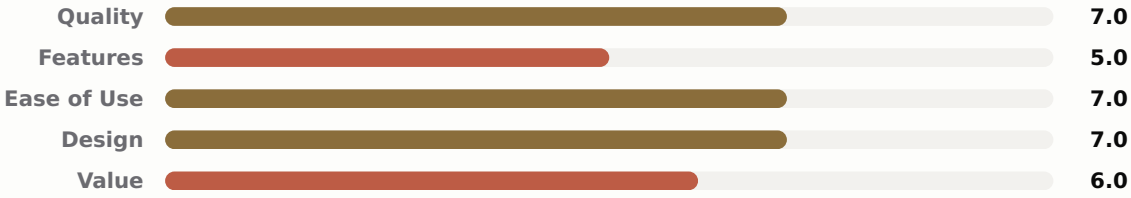
By putting the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without the AutoEmpty Dock) head-to-head with the Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum, you'll see which specs truly impact your daily routine and make a confident, cost-effective choice.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Core Decision Factors — What to evaluate before buying

- **Suction power (Pa)** – lifts embedded dirt and pet hair from carpets.
- **Mopping capability** – built-in water tank and vibrating pad handle light spills on hard floors.
- **Self-empty dock** – holds up to 60 days of debris, cutting manual bin emptying.
- **Navigation technology** – LiDAR or vSLAM maps rooms efficiently, reducing missed spots.
- **Battery life** – longer runtime means fewer recharges for multi-level homes.
- **App and voice control** – scheduling, zone cleaning, Alexa/Google Assistant compatibility.
- **Noise level** – quieter operation for babies or remote workers.
- **Price-to-value ratio** – balances upfront cost with expected consumables and durability.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock (check price on Amazon) pairs a 4-stage cleaning system, a vibrating mopping pad, and a dock that stores up to 60 days of debris.

Why it fits many homes: strong suction (≈2,200 Pa), reliable vSLAM navigation, and the self-empty dock let you set it and forget it — ideal for pet owners or larger floor plans.

Trade-off: the dock adds to the upfront price, but you save time on bin emptying.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (Dock-Free)

The dock-free version (check price on Amazon) keeps the same suction and mopping tech while lowering the cost.

Best for: apartments, small homes, or anyone who prefers to empty the bin manually every few days.

Proof: users report ≈*90 %* pickup on carpet and effective daily mopping on tile.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

The Shark AI Ultra (check price on Amazon) boasts a powerful suction rating (≈2,700 Pa) and Shark's self-cleaning brush roll, which tackles pet hair with fewer tangles.

Why it stands out: superior pet-hair pickup, solid LiDAR navigation, and a large dustbin that reduces emptying frequency — though it lacks an integrated mopping pad.

Consideration: if you need mopping, you'll need a separate device or manual wipe-down.

Which robot vacuum should you buy?

If you want hands-free emptying and light mopping for a medium-to-large home, the **Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** delivers the best overall value.

If pet hair is your top priority and you don't need mopping, the **Shark AI Ultra** gives stronger suction at a comparable price.

For tighter budgets or smaller spaces where you don't mind emptying the bin yourself, the **Roomba 115X Combo (dock-free)** saves money without sacrificing core performance.

Ready to decide? See current prices and buy the model that matches your lifestyle.